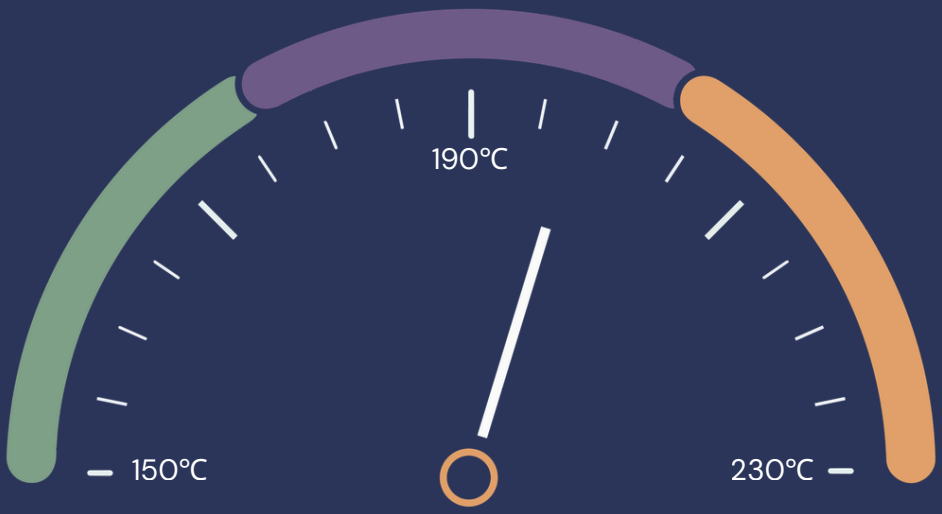


Vaporisation Glossary

A patient's guide to temperatures, vaporisation points and device terms, in plain English.

Medicinal Cannabis UK CIC
Written by patients, for patients

mcukcic.co.uk

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

About this guide

A plain-English reference for UK patients who vaporise prescribed cannabis flower. Use it to look up a word you've heard, check what a temperature setting means, or get to know a new device.

Who it's for

Patients using dry herb vaporisers or thermal extraction devices, and the people who support them. No prior knowledge needed.

Who wrote it

Written by patients, for patients at Medicinal Cannabis UK CIC.
Contributors: Lee Bailey & Lex Wolfe

Please read

This guide is general information, not medical advice. Always follow the guidance of your prescribing clinician and pharmacist, and the instructions that came with your device. Don't change your dose or how you take your medicine without talking to your clinic first.

A note on brand names

We mention some devices and accessories by name because that's how patients talk about them. These are examples only, not recommendations or endorsements. MCUK has no commercial relationship with any manufacturer named in this guide.

Keeping it up to date

Devices, research and the law all change. Check you have the latest version at mcukcic.co.uk. If you spot something that's wrong or missing, please tell us at hello@mcukcic.co.uk.

FIND YOUR WAY

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GETTING STARTED

How to use this guide

You don’t need to read it front to back. Dip in when you meet a new word, try a new device or want to check a temperature.

Reading a glossary entry

Session Heating & use

A heating mode where the device stays hot for a set time, so you can take several draws.
Good to know: how long it stays on, and whether it heats between draws, varies by device.

1 · THE WORD
With its category tag

2 · WHAT IT MEANS
One plain sentence

3 · GOOD TO KNOW
Tips and caveats, if any

Colour Key

Every glossary word has a tag showing what kind of term it is. The name is always written on the tag, so you don’t need to rely on colour.

Devices
Types of vaporiser and heater

Heating & use
How heat works and how you use your device

Parts & Accessories
Pieces of kit, glass and cleaning supplies

Plant & medicine
Words about your flower and your treatment

If you’re tired or foggy today

- Use the contents page to jump straight to what you need.
- Temperatures are given in °C first, with °F underneath for devices that use it.
- In the tables, look up only the compounds named on your product label.
- Use the settings log on page 28 so you don’t have to remember what worked.

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SECTION 1

Safety first

A few essentials that apply whichever device you use.

Avoid combustion

Smoke, ash, a harsh or burnt taste, or black flower means it has burnt. Lower the temperature, and with stick vapes heat more gently.

Hot parts burn

Caps, tips, bowls and induction heater coils get very hot. Use a magnet or debowler, and let parts cool before you touch them.

Cleaning Alcohol is flammable

Keep isopropyl alcohol away from flames and heaters. Rinse and fully dry every part before heating it again.

Look after batteries

Use the charger and cable recommended for your device. Don't charge it overnight or on soft furnishings. Stop using it if it swells or gets unusually hot.

Your device is personal

Don't share mouthpieces or devices. Your prescription is for you alone, and it's illegal to supply it to anyone else.

Keep it labelled

Store your medicine in its pharmacy packaging. When you're out, carry your prescription or a letter from your clinic.

Driving

Don't drive if your medicine affects your ability to drive safely. Speak to your clinic about driving and the law.

Children and pets

Store medicine, devices and accessories out of reach, ideally locked away.

Feeling unwell or had a reaction?

Contact your prescribing clinic or call NHS 111. In an emergency, call 999. You can report side effects to the MHRA through the Yellow Card scheme: yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk. For a faulty device, see page 29.

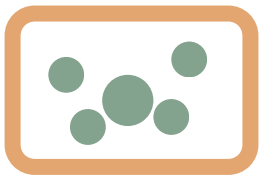
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SECTION 2

Vaporising basics

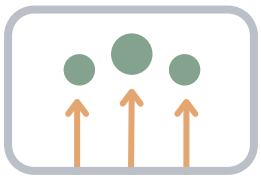
A vaporiser heats flower enough to release its active compounds as vapour, without burning it.

Three ways to heat



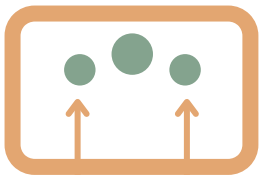
Conduction

Heat passes from a hot surface, like the chamber wall, into the flower touching it.



Convection

Air is heated first, then drawn through the flower when you inhale.



Hybrid

A mix of both. Most modern portable devices work this way.

What changes as the temperature rises

Patients often describe it like this. Everyone's experience differs, so be guided by your clinic and by how you feel.

Lower: about 160–180°C
Lighter, thinner vapour with more flavour. Often a good place to start.

Middle: about 180–200°C
Fuller vapour. A common everyday range for many devices.

Higher: about 200–220°C
Dense, warmer vapour that can feel harsh. Closer to the point of burning.

Temperature stepping

Starting low and raising the temperature a little at a time during a session.
Many patients find it gives smoother vapour and a better feel for what each setting does.

What used flower tells you

Light → Golden → Brown → Black

Black usually means it burnt. Colour is only a rough guide: it can't tell you how much is left.

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SECTION 3

Device types at a glance

Your clinic or pharmacy may suggest a device. This overview helps you understand what each type is like to use. Brand names are examples only.

Portable dry herb vaporiser

e.g. TinyMight 2, Storz & Bickel Mighty+ / Mighty Medic, Frolic

A battery-powered handheld with a heating chamber. You set the temperature and it does the rest.

Battery **Conduction, convection or hybrid** **Easy to start with**

Desktop vaporiser

e.g. Storz & Bickel Volcano / Volcano Medic, Arizer XQ2

A larger, plug-in device. Often very steady temperature control, and some use a bag or whip.

Mains power **Usually convection** **Stays at home**

Stick vape / TED

e.g. DynaVap, Simrell, Vaphit, Tempest 2

A small, battery-free tube heated with a torch lighter or induction heater. Many click when they reach temperature.

No battery **External heat source** **Takes some practice**

Ball vape

e.g. Universal Baller, Ruby Twist, WOHW

A heated head packed with balls that hold heat, connected to a controller and usually used with glass or a bubbler.

Mains power **Mostly convection** **Set-up and glass needed**

Induction heater (IH)

e.g. DynaVap DynaTec Apollo 2, DynaTec Orion V2, The Wand by Ispire

A heat source rather than a vaporiser. It heats the metal tip of a compatible stick vape using a magnetic field, so no flame is needed.

Battery or mains **Flame-free** **Check compatibility**

ⓘ Some devices, such as the Mighty Medic and Volcano Medic, are certified as medical devices. Your clinic may only support certain devices, so check with them before you buy one.

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SECTION 4

Reading the temperature tables

The next eight pages list cannabinoids (pages 9–12) and terpenes (pages 13–16). The tables are on landscape pages.

What each column means

Compound	The common name, with the full chemical name underneath.
Intoxicating / Taste	Cannabinoids: whether it's known to make you feel "high". Terpenes: how it's commonly described to taste or smell.
Vaporisation point	The temperature at which the compound turns to vapour, as reported in the literature. "Decarboxylates" means heat converts it into another compound before it vaporises.
Battery vape	A suggested setting range on a typical battery vaporiser.
Ball vape PID	A suggested range on a ball vape controller. It's higher because the controller measures heat at the coil, not at the flower.
Known properties	What research has looked at so far. Notes such as "animal", "in vitro" or "preclinical" mean it hasn't been shown in people yet.
UK legal status	Cannabinoids only. A summary at the time of writing. The law changes, so check the current position.

Why figures vary between sources

Different studies measure in different ways, and many charts online copy each other's mistakes. What reaches the flower also depends on your device, how it's packed and how hard you draw. Treat every number here as a starting point, not a rule. Our sources, and how the setting ranges were worked out, are on pages 30–31.

These tables are not dosing advice

They can't tell you how a cultivar will affect you, and the properties listed are not proven treatments. Your prescriber decides your medicine and dose. If you want to change how you use it, talk to your clinic first.

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Cannabinoids (1 of 4)

°C shown first, °F underneath

Compound	Intoxicating	Vaporisation point	Battery vape	Ball vape PID	Formula	Known properties	UK legal status
THC Δ9-Tetrahydrocannabinol	Yes	**157°C** 315°F	**175–200°C** 347–392°F	**245–270°C** 473–518°F	$C_{21}H_{30}O_2$	CB1/CB2 partial agonist; analgesic, antiemetic, appetite stimulant, muscle relaxant, sleep aid; anxiety and short-term memory impairment at higher doses	Class B; Schedule 1 (Schedule 2 when in a prescribed cannabis-based medicine)
THCA Tetrahydrocannabinolic acid	No	**Decarboxylates ~105–145°C** ~221–293°F	N/A Converts to THC	N/A Converts to THC	$C_{22}H_{30}O_4$	Anti-inflammatory, antiemetic, neuroprotective (preclinical); converts to THC with heat	Not named in the Act; government consulting on Class B control. Controlled when in cannabis flower
Delta-8-THC Δ8-Tetrahydrocannabinol	Yes (milder)	**175–178°C** 347–352°F	**180–200°C** 356–392°F	**250–270°C** 482–518°F	$C_{21}H_{30}O_2$	Similar to THC at roughly half to two-thirds potency; antiemetic, appetite stimulant; only trace amounts in flower	Class B (cannabinol derivative); Schedule 1
THCV Tetrahydrocannabivarin	Low dose: no; high dose: mild	**~220°C** ~428°F	**205–220°C** 401–428°F	**275–290°C** 527–554°F	$C_{19}H_{26}O_2$	CB1 antagonist at low doses; appetite suppression, improved blood sugar control (small human trials)	Class B (cannabinol derivative); Schedule 1
CBD Cannabidiol	No	**160–180°C** 320–356°F	**180–200°C** 356–392°F	**250–270°C** 482–518°F	$C_{21}H_{30}O_2$	Anticonvulsant (licensed for epilepsy), anxiolytic, anti-inflammatory, antipsychotic (trials); may soften some THC side effects; interacts with liver-metabolised drugs	Not controlled; consumer products regulated as novel foods
CBDA Cannabidiolic acid	No	**Decarboxylates ~120–150°C** ~248–302°F	N/A Converts to CBD	N/A Converts to CBD	$C_{22}H_{30}O_4$	Antiemetic, anti-inflammatory (preclinical); converts to CBD with heat	Not controlled

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Cannabinoids (2 of 4)

°C shown first, °F underneath

Compound	Intoxicating	Vaporisation point	Battery vape	Ball vape PID	Formula	Known properties	UK legal status
CBDV Cannabidivarin	No	**~180°C** ~356°F	**185–205°C** 365–401°F	**255–275°C** 491–527°F	$C_{19}H_{26}O_2$	Anticonvulsant (animal); trialled in epilepsy and autism with mixed results	Not controlled
CBG Cannabigerol	No	**~200°C** ~392°F	**190–210°C** 374–410°F	**260–280°C** 500–536°F	$C_{21}H_{32}O_2$	Antibacterial (incl. MRSA), anti-inflammatory (gut inflammation models), appetite stimulant, neuroprotective (preclinical)	Not controlled
CBGA Cannabigerolic acid	No	**Decarboxylates ~120–150°C** ~248–302°F	N/A Converts to CBG	N/A Converts to CBG	$C_{22}H_{32}O_4$	Mother cannabinoid: the plant converts it into THCA, CBDA and CBCA	Not controlled
CBN Cannabinol	Mild	**185°C** 365°F	**190–205°C** 374–401°F	**260–275°C** 500–527°F	$C_{21}H_{26}O_2$	THC breakdown product, increases as flower ages; mildly sedating (sleep claims are contested), antibacterial	Class B (named); Schedule 1
CBC Cannabichromene	No	**220°C** 428°F	205–220°C 401–428°F	**275–290°C** 527–554°F	$C_{21}H_{30}O_2$	Anti-inflammatory, analgesic, antidepressant-like (animal); supports nerve cell growth (in vitro)	Not controlled
CBL Cannabicyclol	No	Uncertain Uncertain	N/A Trace	N/A Trace	$C_{21}H_{30}O_2$	Forms from CBC under light exposure; very little studied	Not controlled
THCVA Tetrahydrocannabivarinic acid	No	**Decarboxylates** No data	N/A Converts to THCV	N/A Converts to THCV	$C_{20}H_{26}O_4$	Acid precursor of THCV; little studied	Not named in the Act. Controlled when in cannabis flower
CBDVA Cannabidivarinic acid	No	**Decarboxylates** No data	N/A Converts to CBDV	N/A Converts to CBDV	$C_{20}H_{26}O_4$	Acid precursor of CBDV; little studied	Not controlled

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Cannabinoids (3 of 4)

°C shown first, °F underneath

Compound	Intoxicating	Vaporisation point	Battery vape	Ball vape PID	Formula	Known properties	UK legal status
CBCA Cannabichromenic acid	No	**Decarboxylates** No data	N/A Converts to CBC	N/A Converts to CBC	$C_{22}H_{30}O_4$	Antibacterial incl. MRSA (in vitro); acid precursor of CBC	Not controlled
CBGVA Cannabigerovarinic acid	No	**Decarboxylates** No data	N/A Converts to CBGV	N/A Converts to CBGV	$C_{20}H_{28}O_4$	Precursor the plant converts into THCVA, CBDVA and CBCVA	Not controlled
CBNA Cannabinolic acid	No	**Decarboxylates** No data	N/A Converts to CBN	N/A Converts to CBN	$C_{22}H_{26}O_4$	Oxidation product of THCA in aged flower; little studied	Not named in the Act. Controlled when in cannabis flower
CBGV Cannabigerovarin	No	No data	No data	No data	$C_{19}H_{28}O_2$	Propyl homologue of CBG; little studied	Not controlled
CBCV Cannabichromevarin	No	No data	No data	No data	$C_{19}H_{26}O_2$	Propyl homologue of CBC; little studied	Not controlled
CBV Cannabivarin	Unknown	No data	No data	No data	$C_{19}H_{22}O_2$	Oxidation product of THCV; little studied	Class B (homologue of cannabinol); Schedule 1
CBE Cannabielsoin	No	No data	No data	No data	$C_{21}H_{30}O_3$	Formed from CBD by oxidation and metabolism; little studied	Not controlled
CBT Cannabitriol	Unknown	No data	No data	No data	$C_{21}H_{30}O_4$	THC oxidation product; little studied	Unclear; not named in the Act
CBND Cannabinodiol	Unknown	No data	No data	No data	$C_{21}H_{26}O_2$	Light-induced breakdown product of CBN; little studied	Unclear; not named in the Act
THCB Tetrahydrocannabutol	Yes	No data	No data	No data	$C_{20}H_{28}O_2$	Butyl homologue of THC; CB1 affinity similar to THC, analgesic in mice; trace in flower	Class B (cannabinol derivative); Schedule 1

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Cannabinoids (4 of 4)

°C shown first, °F underneath

Compound	Intoxicating	Vaporisation point	Battery vape	Ball vape PID	Formula	Known properties	UK legal status
Delta-9-THCP Tetrahydrocannabiphorol	Yes (potent)	No data	No data	No data	$C_{23}H_{34}O_2$	Heptyl homologue of THC; CB1 affinity ~30x THC (in vitro), strong THC-like effects in mice; trace in flower	Class B (cannabinol derivative); Schedule 1
CBDP Cannabidiphorol	No	No data	No data	No data	$C_{23}H_{34}O_2$	Heptyl homologue of CBD; little studied	Not controlled
Delta-10-THC Δ10-Tetrahydrocannabinol	Yes (milder)	No data	N/A Not in flower	N/A Not in flower	$C_{21}H_{30}O_2$	Mostly made from CBD by chemical conversion; weaker than Δ9-THC	Class B (cannabinol derivative); Schedule 1
HHC Hexahydrocannabinol	Yes	No data	N/A Not in flower	N/A Not in flower	$C_{21}H_{32}O_2$	Semi-synthetic, made by hydrogenating THC or CBD; THC-like but less potent; linked to psychosis hospital presentations	Supply illegal under Psychoactive Substances Act 2016; government accepted Class B control (Aug 2025)
THC-O-acetate THC acetate ester	Yes	No data	N/A Not in flower	N/A Not in flower	$C_{23}H_{32}O_3$	Synthetic prodrug of THC; vaping acetate esters can produce ketene, a lung toxicant	Class B (THC ester, caught by generic definition); Schedule 1



Not found in prescribed flowers!

Δ10-THC, HHC and THC-O are made in a lab and are sometimes sold illegally as “legal highs”. They aren’t part of any UK prescription, and their contents and safety are unknown. Never vape them.

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Terpenes (1 of 4)

°C shown first, °F underneath

Compound	Perceived taste	Vaporisation point	Battery vape	Ball vape PID	Formula	Known properties
Bergamotene Bergamotene	Citrus Woody	**258–260°C** 496–500°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{24}$	Little studied; plant signalling compound (insect attraction/defence)
Bisabolol α-Bisabolol	Sweet Creamy	**~314°C** ~597°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{26}O$	Anti-inflammatory, skin-soothing, wound healing, antimicrobial
Borneol Borneol	Camphor Spice	**213°C** 415°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{18}O$	Analgesic, anti-inflammatory, enhances blood-brain barrier permeability
Camphene Camphene	Earthy Forest	**159–162°C** 318–324°F	**160–175°C** 320–347°F	**230–245°C** 446–473°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Antioxidant, lipid-lowering, antifungal
Camphor Camphor	Menthol Woody	**209°C** 408°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{16}O$	Topical analgesic, counterirritant, cough suppressant, decongestant; toxic if ingested
Carene δ-3-Carene	Earthy Sweet	**168°C** 334°F	**160–175°C** 320–347°F	**230–245°C** 446–473°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Anti-inflammatory, supports bone healing (animal); anecdotally drying
Caryophyllene β-Caryophyllene	Spice Gasoline/Petrol	**262–264°C** 504–507°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{24}$	CB2 receptor agonist; anti-inflammatory, analgesic, gastroprotective, possibly anxiolytic
Cedrene α-Cedrene	Woody Sweet	**261–262°C** 502–504°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{24}$	Antiseptic, antifungal, anti-obesity (animal); calming by reputation
Citronellol Citronellol	Rose Bitter	**225°C** 437°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{20}O$	Insect repellent, anti-inflammatory, antimicrobial, blood-pressure lowering (animal)
Cymene p-Cymene	Sweet Citrus	**177°C** 351°F	**170–185°C** 338–365°F	**240–255°C** 464–491°F	$C_{10}H_{14}$	Anti-inflammatory, analgesic, mild antimicrobial

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Terpenes (2 of 4)

°C shown first, °F underneath

Compound	Perceived taste	Vaporisation point	Battery vape	Ball vape PID	Formula	Known properties
Eucalyptol Eucalyptol	Menthol Camphor	**176–177°C** 349–351°F	**170–185°C** 338–365°F	**240–255°C** 464–491°F	$C_{10}H_{18}O$	Anti-inflammatory, mucolytic, bronchodilator, antimicrobial
Alpha-Farnesene α-Farnesene	Spice Mace	**260°C** 500°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{24}$	Antioxidant; plant defence compound; little studied
Beta-Farnesene β-Farnesene	Floral Apple	**~272°C** ~522°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{24}$	Aphid alarm pheromone; claimed anti-inflammatory; little studied
Fenchol Fenchol	Woody Camphor	**201°C** 394°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{18}O$	Antimicrobial, antioxidant, possibly neuroprotective
Geraniol Geraniol	Rose Floral	**230°C** 446°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{18}O$	Antioxidant, anti-inflammatory, antimicrobial, insect repellent, neuroprotective (preclinical)
Guaiol Guaiol	Woody Rose	**288°C** 550°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{26}O$	Antimicrobial, anti-inflammatory, insecticidal
Humulene α-Humulene	Earthy Spice	**~276°C** ~529°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{24}$	Anti-inflammatory, antibacterial; claimed appetite suppressant (weak evidence)
Isoborneol Isoborneol	Musk Woody	**212–214°C** 414–417°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{18}O$	Antiviral (HSV-1, in vitro), antioxidant
Isopulegol Isopulegol	Menthol Herbal	**212°C** 414°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{18}O$	Anticonvulsant, anxiolytic, gastroprotective (animal)

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Terpenes (3 of 4)

°C shown first, °F underneath

Compound	Perceived taste	Vaporisation point	Battery vape	Ball vape PID	Formula	Known properties
Limonene D-Limonene	Citrus / Sour	**177°C** 351°F	**170–185°C** 338–365°F	**240–255°C** 464–491°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Mood-elevating, anxiolytic, antioxidant, eases acid reflux; skin irritant when oxidised
Linalool Linalool	Floral Lavender	**198°C** 388°F	**185–200°C** 365–392°F	**255–270°C** 491–518°F	$C_{10}H_{18}O$	Anxiolytic, sedative, anticonvulsant, analgesic, anti-inflammatory
Menthol Menthol	Herbal Mint	**212–216°C** 414–421°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{20}O$	Cooling, topical analgesic, anti-itch, cough suppressant
Myrcene β-Myrcene	Herbal Musk	**166–168°C** 331–334°F	**160–175°C** 320–347°F	**230–245°C** 446–473°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Sedative, muscle relaxant, analgesic, anti-inflammatory
Cis-Nerolidol Z-Nerolidol	Woody Earthy	**276°C** 529°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{26}O$	Sedative, anxiolytic, antiparasitic, antifungal, skin penetration enhancer
Trans-Nerolidol E-Nerolidol	Woody Floral	**276°C** 529°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{26}O$	Sedative, anxiolytic, antiparasitic, antifungal, skin penetration enhancer
Ocimene Z-β-Ocimene	Herbal Sweet	**174–175°C** 345–347°F	**170–185°C** 338–365°F	**240–255°C** 464–491°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Antiviral, antifungal, anti-inflammatory
Phellandrene α-Phellandrene	Mint Citrus	**171–174°C** 340–345°F	**170–185°C** 338–365°F	**240–255°C** 464–491°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Antifungal, analgesic, anti-inflammatory, possibly antidepressant (animal)
Phytol Phytol	Grass Tea	**~335°C** ~635°F	**215–220°C** 419–428°F	**290–295°C** 554–563°F	$C_{20}H_{40}O$	Anxiolytic, sedative, antimicrobial, anti-inflammatory; vitamin E/K1 precursor

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Terpenes (4 of 4)

°C shown first, °F underneath

Compound	Perceived taste	Vaporisation point	Battery vape	Ball vape PID	Formula	Known properties
Alpha-Pinene α-Pinene	Pine Sharp	**156°C** 313°F	**160–175°C** 320–347°F	**230–245°C** 446–473°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Bronchodilator, anti-inflammatory, antimicrobial, acetylcholinesterase inhibitor
Beta-Pinene β-Pinene	Pine Herbal	**165°C** 329°F	**160–175°C** 320–347°F	**230–245°C** 446–473°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Antimicrobial, possibly antidepressant (animal)
Pulegone Pulegone	Menthol Sweet	**224°C** 435°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{16}O$	Insecticidal; traditionally sedative/antipyretic; hepatotoxic
Sabinene Sabinene	Spice Pine	**163–164°C** 325–327°F	**160–175°C** 320–347°F	**230–245°C** 446–473°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Antioxidant, anti-inflammatory, antifungal
Alpha-Terpinene α-Terpinene	Woody Gasoline/Petrol	**174°C** 345°F	**170–185°C** 338–365°F	**240–255°C** 464–491°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Antioxidant; skin sensitiser
Gamma-Terpinene γ-Terpinene	Citrus Lime	**183°C** 361°F	**185–200°C** 365–392°F	**255–270°C** 491–518°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Antioxidant, antimicrobial
Terpineol α-Terpineol	Floral Citrus	**219°C** 426°F	**200–215°C** 392–419°F	**270–285°C** 518–545°F	$C_{10}H_{18}O$	Sedative, anticonvulsant, anti-inflammatory, antioxidant, antimicrobial
Terpinolene Terpinolene	Floral Herbal	**185°C** 365°F	**185–200°C** 365–392°F	**255–270°C** 491–518°F	$C_{10}H_{16}$	Antioxidant, antifungal, sedative (animal); described as uplifting
Valencene Valencene	Citrus Woody	**~271°C** ~520°F	**210–220°C** 410–428°F	**285–295°C** 545–563°F	$C_{15}H_{24}$	Anti-inflammatory, anti-allergic, insect repellent

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A – Bu

Airpath
Parts & Accessories

The route air and vapour take through your device, from where air enters to the mouthpiece.
Good to know: A glass mouthpiece doesn't mean the whole airpath is glass. Check what each part the vapour touches is made from.

Ash catcher
Parts & Accessories

A small glass piece that fits between your device and a bubbler, catching debris before it reaches the main water pipe.
Good to know: Keeps your bubbler cleaner for longer and is much easier to clean. Types and joint sizes vary, so check it suits your set-up.

AVB / ABV
Plant & medicine

Short for "already vaped bud" or "already been vaped": the flower left over after a session.
Good to know: Its colour is only a rough guide and can't tell you how much active compound remains. Check with your clinic before using it in any other way.

Ball vape
Devices

A desktop set-up with a heated head filled with small balls (often ruby, quartz or sapphire) that store and pass on heat.
Good to know: The head, controller and bowl work together as one system. See Diffuser ball vape and Injector ball vape.

Boost mode
Heating & use

A button or setting that briefly raises the temperature above your usual setting.
Good to know: Handy towards the end of a session, but it can make vapour harsher.

Bowl / chamber (oven)
Parts & Accessories

The part of the device that holds your flower while it's heated.
Good to know: Sizes vary a lot between devices. Your manual will say how much it holds.

Bubbler
Parts & Accessories

A small water pipe that cools and filters vapour as it passes through water.
Good to know: Usually connected with a WPA or a whip. Larger versions are often called water pipes or bongs.

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Bu – Co

Bubbler connection (joint size) Parts & Accessories

The size of the glass joint that connects pieces together: 10 mm, 14 mm or 18 mm.
Good to know: 14 mm and 18 mm are the most common. Joints are also male or female, so check both before buying. See page 26.

Butane torch Parts & Accessories

A refillable lighter with a focused flame, used to heat stick vapes.
Good to know: Heat the cap only and keep the flame moving. Overheating with a torch makes combustion more likely. Never use one near cleaning alcohol.

Cannabinoids Plant & medicine

The active compounds in cannabis, such as THC and CBD.
Good to know: More than 100 have been identified. See the tables on pages 9–12.

Cap and tip Parts & Accessories

On a stick vape, the cap is the metal end you heat; the tip holds the flower underneath it.
Good to know: The cap gets very hot. Let it cool, or use a magnet or debowler to remove it.

Chemovar / cultivar Plant & medicine

A cultivar is a named variety of the plant. A chemovar describes it by its chemical make-up: its cannabinoid and terpene profile.
Good to know: Your product label usually shows THC and CBD content, and sometimes the main terpenes.

"The click" Heating & use

The sound many stick vapes make when the cap reaches temperature, telling you to stop heating.
Good to know: Heating past the click raises the risk of combustion.

Combustion Heating & use

When plant material burns instead of vaporising, producing smoke and ash.
Good to know: This is what you want to avoid. It's more likely at higher temperatures, with hot spots in conduction devices, and when heating a stick vape with a torch lighter.

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Co – De

Concentrates
Plant & medicine

Potent extracts made from the cannabis plant, such as oils, wax, shatter and live rosin.
Good to know: Most UK prescriptions are for flower or oils. Only use a concentrate if it's part of your prescription and suits your device.

Condenser
Parts & Accessories

The inner metal tube running through the middle of most stick vapes, such as DynaVap, Tempest 2 and Simrell.
Good to know: It carries vapour from the tip to the mouthpiece, cooling it and keeping the outer body clean.

Conduction
Heating & use

Heating by direct contact with a hot surface.
Good to know: It can heat unevenly, so stirring the flower part-way through a session often helps.

Convection
Heating & use

Heating with hot air that's drawn through the flower.
Good to know: It usually heats more evenly, but often needs a slower, steadier draw.

Debowler
Parts & Accessories

A small tool or station for emptying used flower out of a chamber cleanly.
Good to know: Many have a central spike to loosen the flower, a pit to catch it, and magnets to pull off hot caps. Some fit straight onto storage jars.

Decarboxylation
Plant & medicine

The change caused by heat that removes carbon dioxide from acid cannabinoids, for example turning THCA into THC.
Good to know: It happens automatically when you vaporise. It doesn't mean everything has been extracted, or that a dose is safe.

Desktop vaporiser
Devices

A larger, mains-powered vaporiser used at home.
Good to know: Usually gives steady temperature control. Some fill a bag; others use a whip.

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DHV – Dr

DHV: dry herb vaporiser

Devices

A device that heats cannabis flower without burning it, so you can inhale your prescribed flower as vapour.

Good to know: The umbrella term for portable, desktop and stick vaporisers.

Diffuser ball vape

Devices

A ball vape head that caps over or around the bowl's outer rim and gently spreads heat across the flower.

Good to know: It combines hot air (convection) with heat from the bowl itself (conduction).

Direct-to-lung (DTL)

Heating & use

Drawing vapour straight into your lungs in one breath.

Good to know: Suits devices with low draw resistance. Start gently if you're new to it. See Mouth-to-lung.

Distillate

Plant & medicine

A highly refined, concentrated oil, often THC-dominant, made through distillation.

Good to know: Usually contains few or none of the plant's natural terpenes.

Dosing capsule

Parts & Accessories

A small refillable pod you pack in advance and drop into your device.

Good to know: Useful for preparing sessions ahead of time. Commonly made from aluminium, stainless steel or quartz, and some fit several devices.

Draw / hit

Heating & use

Breathing in through the device. A single draw is often called a hit.

Good to know: Slow, steady draws usually give smoother vapour than quick ones.

Draw resistance

Heating & use

How hard it is to pull air through the device.

Good to know: Tighter draws suit mouth-to-lung; looser draws suit direct-to-lung. Packing more tightly increases resistance. This can be adjusted on some devices.

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Fl – IH

Flower
Plant & medicine

The dried bud of the cannabis plant: the form most vaporisers are designed for.
Good to know: Your pharmacy label shows the product name and its THC and CBD content.

Gravity infuser
Parts & Accessories

A rotating glass device, such as the Stündenglass, that uses water and gravity to fill a chamber with vapour.
Good to know: You don't need to draw hard to use it, which some patients find easier.

Grinder
Parts & Accessories

A tool that breaks flower into smaller, even pieces before you load it.
Good to know: How fine you grind changes airflow and heating. Your device manual will usually suggest a texture.

Haptic feedback
Heating & use

A vibration from the device, for example when it's ready or a session ends.
Good to know: Helpful if you can't easily see the screen or lights.

Heat-up time
Heating & use

How long the device takes to reach the temperature you've set.
Good to know: Ranges from a few seconds to a couple of minutes, depending on the device.

Hybrid heating
Heating & use

A combination of conduction and convection.
Good to know: Most modern portable vaporisers work this way.

IH: induction heater
Devices

A heater that warms a compatible metal part using a magnetic field, with no flame.
Good to know: Glass and quartz can't be heated this way. How the heat then reaches the flower depends on the device.

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In – On

Injector ball vape
Devices

A ball vape head with a tapered nozzle that slots into a glass or metal bowl and pushes air through the flower to heat.
Good to know: The balls inside, often ruby, quartz or sapphire, hold heat and pass it on to the air.

ISO / IPA: isopropyl alcohol
Parts & Accessories

A cleaning alcohol that dissolves resin from glass and metal parts.
Good to know: Use a high-purity grade (99% or above). It's highly flammable: rinse and fully dry parts before heating them. Don't soak seals, DynaVap caps or electronics.

J-hook
Parts & Accessories

A curved glass mouthpiece that looks a bit like a Sherlock Holmes pipe.
Good to know: It cools the vapour before it reaches you. Some have glass beads or balls inside for extra cooling.

Kief
Plant & medicine

The fine, crystal-like resin glands (trichomes) that fall off cannabis flower.
Good to know: It often collects in the bottom of a grinder.

Microdosing
Plant & medicine

An everyday term for using small amounts.
Good to know: There's no agreed definition or dose. Follow the dose your prescriber has set.

Mouth-to-lung (MTL)
Heating & use

Drawing vapour into your mouth first, then breathing it into your lungs.
Good to know: Many people find it gentler. See Direct-to-lung.

On-demand
Heating & use

Heating only while you need it, usually while you hold down a button.
Good to know: It doesn't mean you get the same amount of active compound with each draw.

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Pa – Po

Packing
Heating & use

How you load flower into the chamber: loosely or tightly.
Good to know: It affects airflow and heating. Conduction devices often work best packed firmly; convection devices often prefer a looser pack.

Pass-through (airflow / carb)
Parts & Accessories

A built-in air hole on a piece of glass or a device.
Good to know: Lets you clear the chamber or control airflow without removing the device. Not the same as pass-through charging.

Pass-through charging
Heating & use

Using a device while it's plugged in and charging.
Good to know: Not every device supports it. Charging and heating at the same time can make the battery hot, so check your manual first.

Percolator ("perc")
Parts & Accessories

A built-in filter inside a water pipe that breaks vapour into lots of tiny bubbles.
Good to know: It cools and smooths the vapour, but adds draw resistance and needs regular cleaning.

PID controller
Parts & Accessories

A digital controller that holds a heater at a set temperature by constantly adjusting its power, including when you inhale.
Good to know: Used with ball vapes and many desktop devices. It measures at the heater, so the number on screen isn't the temperature at your flower.

Portable vaporiser
Devices

A battery-powered handheld vaporiser.
Good to know: Usually the easiest type to start with. Battery life and heat-up time vary between models.

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Pr – TED

Prescribed dose
Plant & medicine

The amount of medicine your prescriber has said you can use.
Good to know: Usually given in grams per day. Chambers vary in size, so ask your clinic how this translates to your device.

Reclaim / resin
Parts & Accessories

The sticky residue that builds up inside your device and glass.
Good to know: A sign it's time to clean. Don't scrape it out to reuse.

Recycler
Parts & Accessories

A type of water pipe that moves water and vapour round a loop of connected chambers as you draw.
Good to know: It cools vapour well, but takes some practice and more cleaning.

Scoop
Parts & Accessories

A small spoon or tool for loading flower into a chamber.
Good to know: Helps keep amounts consistent, especially with ball vapes and some battery devices.

Screen
Parts & Accessories

A fine mesh that keeps flower in the chamber and out of the airpath.
Good to know: Replace it if it clogs or bends.

Session
Heating & use

A heating mode where the device stays hot for a set time, so you can take several draws.
Good to know: How long it stays on, and whether it heats between draws, depends on the device.

Stick vape
Devices

A small, battery-free, tube-shaped vaporiser heated with a torch or induction heater.
Good to know: Examples include DynaVap, Simrell, Vaphit and Tempest 2.

TED: thermal extraction device
Devices

A dry herb vaporiser heated by an outside source, such as a torch lighter or induction heater.
Good to know: It works the same way as other DHVs; only the heat source is different.

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Te – WPA

Temperature stepping
Heating & use

Starting at a low temperature and raising it gradually during a session.
Good to know: Many patients find it gives smoother vapour. See page 6.

Terpenes
Plant & medicine

Aromatic compounds that give each cultivar its smell and taste.
Good to know: See the tables on pages 13–16.

THCA
Plant & medicine

The acid form of THC found in raw flower. It isn't intoxicating until heat converts it into THC.
Good to know: This conversion is called decarboxylation.

Titration
Plant & medicine

Gradually adjusting your dose, with your clinic, until you find what works for you.
Good to know: Usually means starting low and going slowly.

Tolerance
Plant & medicine

When the same amount of medicine starts to have less effect over time.
Good to know: If you notice this, talk to your clinic rather than raising your dose yourself.

Vapour density
Heating & use

How thick or visible the vapour looks.
Good to know: Thicker vapour doesn't always mean more medicine. Some compounds are released with very little visible vapour.

Whip
Parts & Accessories

A length of hose that connects a device or bubbler at one end to a mouthpiece at the other.
Good to know: Sometimes called a hookah hose. Use tubing that's safe for heat and replace it regularly.

WPA: water pipe adapter
Parts & Accessories

An adapter, usually glass, that connects your device to a bubbler or water pipe.
Good to know: Check the joint size and whether it's male or female. See page 26.

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SECTION 6

Connections & accessories

If you use glass or a water pipe, the pieces need to fit together. Two things matter: the size of the joint and whether it's male or female.

Joint sizes



10 mm

Least common. Small bubblers and some adapters

14 mm

Very common. Most bubblers and WPAs

18 mm

Very common. Larger water pipes

Male or female? A male joint slides into another piece; a female joint is the opening that receives it. You always need one of each, in the same size. Adapters can convert between sizes and genders.

How a typical set-up fits together



Check every joint along the way. Each one needs to match its neighbour in size and in male/female fit.

Before you buy glass

- Check your device's manual for the WPA or adapter it's designed to use.
- Measure or check the joint on your bubbler, not just the product photo.
- Water adds draw resistance, so convection devices may feel different with glass.
- Change the water after every session and clean glass regularly.

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SECTION 7

Cleaning & care

A clean device tastes better, heats more evenly and lasts longer. Always check your manual first: some parts must never get wet.

A basic deep clean

1. Make sure the device is off, unplugged and completely cool.
2. Remove the parts your manual says are safe to clean: usually glass, mouthpieces, screens and metal stems.
3. Soak them in isopropyl alcohol (99% or above) in a sealed bag or jar until the resin loosens.
4. Scrub with cotton buds or pipe cleaners, then rinse well in warm water.
5. Let everything dry completely, ideally overnight, before you put it back together and heat it.

Little and often

- Brush out the chamber after each session
- Change bubbler water every time
- Wipe the mouthpiece regularly
- Deep clean when the draw feels tight or tastes off

Never soak

- Electronics, batteries or heaters
- Rubber or silicone seals and O-rings, unless the manual says it's fine
- Wooden parts
- Anything your manual says to keep dry

⚠ Isopropyl alcohol is highly flammable. Use it in a well-ventilated room, away from flames, torches and heaters, and store it with the lid closed.

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SECTION 8

My settings log

Note down what works for you, so you don't have to remember. It can also help when you talk to your clinic. Print as many copies as you need.

Date	Device	Product/Cultivar	Temp	How it felt/Notes

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SECTION 9

Further support

Talk to MCUK

We're a patient-led community. If you have a question about anything in this guide, get in touch or join the conversation.

Website · mcukcic.co.uk

Email · hello@mcukcic.co.uk

Facebook · groups/mcuk.cic

Instagram · @mcuk.cic

Discord · discord.gg/m5HajJPPj2

YouTube · @MCUK-CIC

Other places to get help

Your clinic	For anything about your prescription, dose or side effects.
Your pharmacist	For questions about your medicine, its label or how it's supplied.
Device manufacturer	For set-up, cleaning, faults and warranty. Keep your manual.
NHS 111	If you feel unwell and it isn't an emergency. In an emergency, call 999.
MHRA Yellow Card	Report side effects from your medicine, or a problem with a certified medical device, at yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk. In Scotland, medical device incidents are reported to IRIC instead.
Faulty or unsafe device	Contact the manufacturer or retailer. For safety issues, such as a battery overheating, you can also report it to Trading Standards through the Citizens Advice Consumer Helpline.



Want to check where a number or a claim came from? Our full sources and methodology are on pages 30–31.

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WHERE OUR INFORMATION COMES FROM

Sources & methodology

Methodology note

Vaporiser setting ranges, including the ball vape PID settings, are editorial estimates based on relative volatility and user testing on a range of devices. They are not drawn from published research. Where data is missing or unreliable, this is marked in the tables. Legal status is correct as of October 2026.

Physical data (boiling points, chemical formulas)

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Reporting side effects and faulty products

Medicines and Healthcare products Regulatory Agency. The Yellow Card scheme: guidance for healthcare professionals, patients and the public. gov.uk/guidance/the-yellow-card-scheme-guidance-for-healthcare-professionals-patients-and-the-public

Citizens Advice. Reporting to Trading Standards. citizensadvice.org.uk/consumer/get-more-help/report-to-trading-standards/

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A knowledgeable, understanding support system, made by patients who've been where you are.

Medicinal Cannabis UK CIC is a patient-led community interest company supporting people in the UK who are prescribed cannabis-based medicines. We share clear, honest information, so no one has to work it out alone.

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